The procedure is more or less similar for RPM-based distributions where dependencies are not a problem.

If you have an RPM or DEB package for a particular program, but your distribution is not compatible with RPM or DEB files, there are a number of ways to install the program onto your machine despite this. Deb packages use tarballs as a component of their packaging. Extracting these tarballs from the packaging is a relatively easy process. Open the terminal, and type

```
$ ar -x package.deb
```

The process for installing RPM packages on debian-based distributions is not as simple as that, and requires a little more effort. One common program that people use is called Alien. The software is available for download at http://tinyurl.com/alienlin.

Although unstable, and may not work well with all the packages, but is the most probable solution. You will also need to download the RPM package manager for converting to and from RPM,

which is available at http://www.rpm.org. An easier method is to go out and find a source tarball for the same software.

Use the package manager to install Alien.

Alien has an unusually long list of dependencies that need to be resolved. Installing Alien on an RPM-based distribution is